**EXECUTIVE SUMMARY**

**Team Building:** scaled multiple engineering organizations from 2 to 40 engineers

**Strategic Vision:** Transformed legacy apps into resilient hybrid-cloud architectures for Fortune 100 clients

**Client Relationships:** Grew key accounts from proof-of-concept to multi-million-dollar engagements


**Contact**

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**TECHNICAL EXPERTISE**

**Languages:** .Net, C#, ASP .Net, Python, R, Java, JavaScript, Visual Basic, SQL, PowerShell

**Cloud & Infrastructure:** Azure, GCP, AWS serverless architectures

**Data & Analytics:** ML predictors, computer vision, sales forecasting, data engineering, self-serve dashboards

**Software Development:** Microservices, API-driven development, DevOps mindset, Agile methods

**EDUCATION**

**Master of Computer Science**
specialization in Data Science
University of Illinois

**Bachelor of Science in Business Administration,** with honors
University of Alabama

Dual major: MIS, Philosophy
Minors: Computer Science, Honors Research

# RJ Cantrell

Technology executive with 15 years of leadership experience driving digital transformation and building high-performance engineering teams across fintech, retail, logistics, and enterprise software. Proven track record of scaling technical organizations, leading cloud migrations, and delivering AI/ML solutions that directly impact revenue. Combines strategic vision with deep technical expertise to align technology initiatives with business objectives.

**EXPERIENCE**

**FOUNDER & PRINCIPAL,** BREAKFALL TECHNOLOGIES
Sep 2022 – Jun 2023, Jan 2026 – Present Denver, CO

- Fractional, advisory, and project-based work between full-time roles
- Spearheaded hybrid cloud migration strategy for multi-location enterprise, improving scalability while maintaining business continuity
- Served as Head of Engineering for .Net startup of 12 engineers in two locations including DevOps, QA strategy, and AI adoption
- Improved sprint delivery from 31% completion to consistently 75+%
- Designed customer-facing ML analytics engine for project-management app, giving probabilistic visibility into sprint outcomes
- Built internal ML-driven log analysis system to proactively detect anomalies and analyze usage patterns
- Built multi-agent research/monitoring system (LangGraph, LangFuse, LiteLLM) with human-in-the-loop approval and governance controls

**STAFF SOFTWARE ENGINEER,** THE HOME DEPOT
Jun 2023 – Jan 2026 Denver, CO (remote)

- Built sales-forecasting ML models for "what-if" pricing experiments, increasing agility of omni-channel retail strategy
- Demand-transfer ML models supporting single-store, regional, and national pricing strategy across SKUs, classes, and departments
- Cut training/validation timelines from days to hours through MLOps pipelines and cloud data engineering
- Integrated microservices into .com search results, product pages, and point-of-sale systems, driving growth of conversion and revenue
- Mentored and built prototypes with AI-adoption employee group

**DIRECTOR OF SOFTWARE DELIVERY**, WINESHIPPING
Nov 2021 – Sep 2022 Napa, CA (remote)

- Led global technology organization with distributed teams totaling around 40 engineers across US, India, and Europe
- Drove post-acquisition technology integration strategy, successfully unifying disparate systems and creating a consolidated data ecosystem in Azure
- Modernized .Net monolith in-place into event-based microservices with no downtime while integrating acquired competitor's with no customer disruption. Strategically addressing hotspots with webhooks and caching reduced operational costs by an order of magnitude.
- Designed data analytics products leveraging shipping manifests to provide consumer behavior insights to wine industry partners

**DIRECTOR OF TECHNOLOGY**, KIN + CARTA (now Valtech) Apr 2019 - Nov 2021 Denver, CO

- Grew strategic account from single proof-of-concept to company's largest, delivering 52% gross margin; expanded from two-person team to 30+ across four cross-functional product teams
- Built and led high-performing technology teams for mission-critical applications in heavily regulated industries, including utilities and oil/gas pipeline operations
- Established technical hiring strategy and standards, personally evaluating and onboarding 20% of agency's technical talent
- Delivered enterprise data platform driving operational efficiency for utilities client, contributing to successful acquisition by industry leader
- Managed P&L responsibility for largest client account, consistently exceeding gross margin targets while maintaining exceptional client-satisfaction metrics

**TECHNICAL TEAM LEAD**, SUNTRUST BANKS (now Truist) Feb 2014 - Mar 2019 Atlanta, GA

- Led digital transformation initiatives for legacy banking systems, establishing modern development practices within traditional financial institution, significantly reducing lead-time and defect rate
- Architected service-oriented platform that enabled rapid product development and improved time-to-market for banking products
- Developed and implemented engineering excellence program, elevating code quality standards across multiple development teams

**TEAM LEAD**, KABBAGE (acquired by American Express) Mar 2012 – Jan 2014 Atlanta, GA

- Architected ML-powered credit underwriting engine that became the core of Kabbage's lending platform, enabling lending to underserved communities without relying on credit score
- Led development of scalable data integration platform connecting to 15+ APIs (Amazon, eBay, QuickBooks, social media), creating unique alternative data assets for risk assessment
- Partnered with CIO to develop technical roadmap and vendor strategy
- Established cloud infrastructure strategy and tooling to dramatically reduce operational costs despite increased transaction volume and headcount
- Built and mentored cross-functional product delivery team, implementing agile methodologies that improved DORA metrics and employee satisfaction

**EARLY CAREER HIGHLIGHTS**

- Led enterprise application modernization for Fortune 500 clients across retail, telecom, government, logistics and financial services sectors
- Pioneered mobile application development for retail inventory management system at The Home Depot, incorporating direct store-level user feedback as well as predictive supply-chain replenishment
- Architected conversion of mission-critical application supporting billions in revenue from legacy C++ to modern architecture at UPS
- Developed early AI/ML implementations for logistics optimization at BellSouth (now AT&T)

**CONSULTING LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE**

- Managed distributed teams for client engagements at Avanade, a Microsoft/Accenture joint venture
- Served as technical relationship manager for public sector contracts, balancing government requirements with delivery constraints

**NOTABLE ACHIEVEMENTS**

- Implemented computer-vision system delivering $2.5M/yr savings in manufacturing for The Westervelt Co.
- Designed custom mobile device platform for field operations on >100,000 devices at US Postal Service
- Created user analytics framework capturing behavioral insights that informed product strategy
- Regularly delivered technical presentations and demonstrations to C-suite stakeholders